

Projectors

Ultralights Or Personal Projectors are mainly targeted towards the consumer who is mobile and needs to give frequent presentations while on the road—thus the name ultralight. An ultra-sleek portable projector snugly fits in your laptop-carrying case along with other accessories that you need to carry around. The downside is that their brightness levels are not on par with the normal standalone projectors.

Conference Or Training Room Projectors

These are permanently fixed, heavy, and yet portable. An Over Head Projector (OHP) projector is one such example. A dying breed, these cost less and only serve transparencies that are either printed or written upon using special OHP transparency

markers. Thus, they are ideal for use in schools and training institutes.

Fixed Projectors

These are very expensive, versatile and can handle different resolutions and image sizes, easily project in large, bright rooms and offer superior quality over other projectors conveniently positioned out of the way of the audience.

Brightness

The brightness of a projector is usually measured in ANSI lumens. While deciding upon your purchase, do remember that a brightly-lit room will need an even brighter projector lamp. A projector with a specified brightness of around 400-500 lumens, suffices to beam up Excel images in a dark room. However, PowerPoint presenta-

Buying Tips

- ✓ Include the cost of a new lamp and the hours it runs to factor in the continuing cost per hour of the projector. Opt for a unit that offers a lamp life of at least 3,000 hours. Lesser lamp life will add to the overall cost of the projector.
- ✓ 1,024 x 768 is the resolution to look out for, to get sharp visuals and crisp text. 800 x 600 suffices for the 60-inch to 90-inch diagonal screen used just for presentations. 1,024 x 768 is ideal to screen films on a 120-inch diagonal screen.
- ✓ LCD projectors are divided into two categories: standard LCD and the polysilicon LCD projectors.
- ✓ Standard LCD projectors cost less and

have an LCD panel that controls the three primary colours. These projectors are being slowly phased out and replaced with the new polysilicon LCD and DLP projectors.

- ✓ Polysilicon LCD projectors offer better colour saturation since they control colours through three panels and are of a higher quality than standard LCD.
- ✓ DLP or Digital Light Processing projectors are the new breed of projectors which are available in the market. These projectors are considered to be of a better quality than standard LCD projectors and find themselves being used extensively in the high-end home theatre market as in projection TVs. Opt for it if you want a cinematic effect at home.

Ready Reckoner

 You Need	Business presentations in PowerPoint featuring small clip-arts, graphs, etc
Look for	SVGA or XGA resolution projector
 You Need	Design applications
Look for	XGA resolution projector
 You Need	Engineering applications, graphics applications and video-editing applications
Look for	SXGA/UXGA resolution projector

EPSON

tions that involve graphics, clip-arts, etc will appear lifeless. For these, use a projector with a brightness of around 500-1,000 lumens.

Conference rooms need projector lamps rated at 1,000 to 2,000 lumens, while places using fixed projectors need lamps in the range of 2,500 to 10,000 lumens. Note that as brightness ratings increase, projector costs go up as well.

Check the ANSI lumens of each individual projector and not the product line. This is because some manufacturers specify a generic lumens specification for the whole product line.

Pricing

Projectors do not come cheap. Starting at Rs 50,000, they shoot up to around Rs 5 crore. As an example of prices, an SVGA resolution projector will cost you around Rs 1,79,000.